

FOST TRAINING RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FEB 16

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(F) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90% (54 out of 60)

You are the SSD OOW in HMS BULWARK currently berthed port side to (bows East) in Western Mill Plymouth. You are sailing at 0815 on the HW tidal window in order to recover landing craft (LCUs and LCVPs) and embark your air group (2 WCs) before proceeding out of the sound with the rest of your Amphibious Task Group (ATG) consisting of the LSD RFA LYME BAY, The AOR RFA FORT VICTORIA and the Survey Ship HMS ECHO. The intention is then to passage in company East Bound through the Dover Straits and via the North Sea to take part in a NATO amphibious exercise to be held off the coast of Northern Norway. It is the end of February; the weather is fine with visibility in excess of 10 NM although your ever optimistic METO has predicted the passage of a warm front around midday with possible reduction in visibility to less than 0.5 NM. The wind is Easterly at 10-12 knots Sunrise was at 0732 and Sunset is at 1712.

1. It is 0815, SSD are closed up, The SSC are obeying telegraphs and the NO has the ship. Two Tut class tugs are connected Fore and Aft and you commence a tug assisted pull off the berth and stern board out of Western Mill with the intention of turning on to a Southerly departure track. All goes well with the unberthing and as you make your sternboard the NO, conning from the stbd bridge wing, is concerned that other vessels may be obscured by OCEA and unaware of your movements. He orders you to make the required sound signal, what is it and how would it be answered? **(34e)** (2)

2. As you proceed south you spot the Torpoint Ferry, it is RAM. What is the definition of RAM? **(3g)** (2)

3. You pass the ferry safely then see a sailing vessel departing the Torpoint Marina, crossing the channel. What vessel(s) are required not to impede the passage of vessels which or navigating within or can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway? **(9b, c, d)** (3)

4. The sailing vessel does not appear to maintaining a proper lookout and does not appear to have seen you, what do the rules state about maintaining a lookout? **(5)** (2)
5. DMEO who is having a close look at the sailing vessel suggests there may be party onboard explaining why the skipper may not have seen you. Does this exonerate him from maintaining a proper lookout? **(2a)** (2)
6. The sailing vessel is manoeuvring erratically and you are unsure of its intentions, how do you signal this to the sailing vessel? **(34d)** (1)
7. Having negotiated the sailing vessel you proceed through vanguard bank without incident into the Sound. You note various vessels navigating within the sound including a small coaster inbound to Mount Batten. You expect to pass them once clear of Drakes Island, what do the rules state about navigating in narrow channels? **(9a)** (2)
8. The STOM desk advises that the LCVPs and LCUs are running slightly behind and requests you anchor in the sound to allow them to catch up before heading out to sea. What do the rules state about anchoring in a narrow channel? **(9g)** (1)
9. The Navigator directs that you will complete Plymouth out and once clear of the Break Water you will assume the action condition in preparation for recovery of the craft. As you proceed south the concentration of Fishing Vessels increase. What is the definition of a FV? **(3d)** (2)
10. The shipping continues to increase making it more difficult to assess risk of collision. What 2 considerations shall be amongst those taken into account in determining risk of collision exists? **(7d i, ii)** (4)

11. The 200W asks how radar is to be used to assist with early warning of risk of collision. What do you say? **(7b)** (3)

12. With all landing craft recovered Navs takes charge of the TG units and you commence the transit East conducting flying concurrently. The deck landing training is running late, FLYCO request an extension and for you to maintain the course for an additional hour. This would result in entering the TSS separation zone, the 200W asks if this is allowed as you are restricted in ability to manoeuvre? **(10b i, ii)** (2)

13. With the issue resolved still 10nm prior to TSS the port lookout reports a group of yachts ahead. He reports three yachts from R10 to R30. The second yacht is on a steady bearing.

- a) Who is the give way vessel? **(18a)** (1)
- b) What action should you take and what should the result of that action be? **(16 & 8c)** (2)
- c) The last yacht is displaying a cone apex down. What does this indicate? **(25e)** (1)

14. Now clear of the yachts the sky looks ominously black and visibility begins to reduce in the gloom.

- a) Can you display your navigation lights before sunset? **(20c)** (2)
- b) What is the minimum range of your masthead light? **(22a)** (1)
- c) What is the arc of visibility of your stern light? **(21c)** (1)

15. Rain begins to fall reducing visibility to 6nm. At G10 you make out the following lights and assess that the vessel will be passing clear down your starboard side.

		W	W
		R	W
		W	W
		R	
G	G		

- a) What do these lights indicate? **(24a)** (2)
- b) What is the day signal for this vessel? **(24av & 24e)** (2)
- c) In restricted visibility what sound signal and at what interval would this vessel sound if both vessels were manned? **(35c & 35e)** (2)

As the passage is proceeding unhindered and, surprisingly, without the constraint of restricted visibility you decide to quiz your YO on his RoR knowledge.

16. a) i) If main propulsion was lost what type of vessel would you become? **(3f)** (1)
 - ii) What lights would you display by night and; **(27a)** (1)
 - iii) If in restricted visibility, what sound signal would you make? **(35c)** (1)
- b) If you stopped making way though the water what difference, if any, would this make to the lights you would display? **(27a)** (1)
17. Should the ME's not be able to conduct repairs in time and you ran aground what would the day, night and sound signal be in this instance? **(30a, 30d, 35g & 35h)** (2)
18. Unfortunately the starboard lookout interrupts your quiz to report that one of previously reported sailing vessels have altered course and is now closing at G160.
19. a) What type of situation is this and who is give way? **(13a, b)** (2)
 - b) The yacht maintains its course and speed and you determine that a close quarters situation is developing. What sound signal shall you make? **(34d)** (1)
 - c) The yacht carrying on despite repeated sounding of the signal in Q18b. When may you take action to avoid collision by your manoeuvre alone? **(17 aii)** (1)

20. You clear all the Sailing vessels and enter the TSS. You have completed flying but your YO wonders if being RAM for flying made you exempt from following the rules. What is your answer and why? **(10i)** (2)

ANSWERS

1. It is 0815, SSD are closed up, The SSC are obeying telegraphs and the NO has the ship. Two Tut class tugs are connected Fore and Aft and you commence a tug assisted pull off the berth and stern board out of Western Mill with the intention of turning on to a Southerly departure track. All goes well with the unberthing and as you make your stern board the NO, conning from the stbd bridge wing, is concerned that other vessels may be obscured by OCEA and unaware of your movements. He orders you to make the required sound signal, what is it and how would it be answered? **(34e)**

A vessel nearing a bend or an area of a channel or fairway where other vessels may be obscured by an intervening obstruction shall sound one prolonged blast. Such signal shall be **answered with one prolonged blast** by an approaching vessel that may be within hearing around the bend or behind the intervening obstruction."

2. As you proceed south you spot the Torpoint Ferry, it is RAM. What is the definition of RAM? **(3g)**

The term vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre means a vessel which from the nature of her work is restricted in her ability to manoeuvre as required by these rules and is therefore unable to keep out of the way of another vessel.

3. You pass the ferry safely then see a sailing vessel departing the Torpoint Marina, crossing the channel. What vessel(s) are required not to impede the passage of vessels which or navigating within or can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway? **(9b, c, d)**

A vessel of less than 20 metres in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede" "A vessel engaged in fishing shall not impede the passage of any other vessel"... "A vessel shall not cross a narrow channel or fairway if such crossing impedes".....

4. The sailing vessel does not appear to maintaining a proper lookout and does not appear to have seen you, what do the rules state about maintaining a lookout? **(5)**

Every vessel shall at all times maintain a proper and effective lookout by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision.

5. DME0 who is having a close look at the sailing vessel suggests there may be party onboard explaining why the skipper may not have seen you. Does this exonerate him from maintaining a proper lookout? **(2a)**

Nothing in these rules shall exonerate any vessel, or the owner, master or crew thereof, from the consequences of any neglect to comply with these Rules or of the neglect of any precaution which may be required by the ordinary practise of seamen, or by the special circumstances of the case.

6. The sailing vessel is manoeuvring erratically and you are unsure of its intentions, how do you signal this to the sailing vessel? **(34d)**

When a vessel in sight of one another... fail to understand the intentions or actions of the other , or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blasts on the whistle. Such signal may be supplemented by a light signal of at least 5 short and rapid flashes.

7. Having negotiated the sailing vessel you proceed past vanguard bank without incident into the Sound. You note various vessels navigating within the sound including a small coaster inbound to Mount Batten. You expect to pass them once clear of Drakes Island, what do the rules state about navigating in narrow channels? **(9a)**

A vessel proceeding along the course of a narrow channel or fairway shall keep as near to the outer limit of the channel or fairway which lies on her starboard side as is safe and practicable.

8. The STOM desk advises that the LCVPs and LCUs are running slightly behind and requests you anchor in the sound to allow them to catch up before heading out to sea. What do the rules state about anchoring in a narrow channel? **(9g)**

Any vessel shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid anchoring in a narrow channel.

9. The Navigator directs that you will complete Plymouth out and once clear of the Break Water you will assume the action condition in preparation for recovery of the craft. As you proceed south, the concentration of Fishing Vessels increase. What is the definition of a FV? **(3d)**

The term “vessel engaged in fishing” means any vessel fishing with nets, lines, trawls or other fishing apparatus which restrict manoeuvrability, but does not include a vessel fishing with trolling lines or other fishing apparatus which does not restrict manoeuvrability.

10. The shipping continues to increase making it more difficult to assess risk of collision. What 2 considerations shall be amongst those taken into account in determining risk of collision exists? **(7d i, ii)**

- i) Such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change.**
- ii) Such risk may sometimes exist even when an appreciable bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or tow or when approaching a vessel at close range.**

11. The 200W asks how RADAR is to be used to assist with early warning of risk of collision. What do you say? **(7b)**

Proper use shall be made of radar equipment if fitted and operational, including long range scanning to obtain early warning of risk of collision and radar plotting or equivalent systematic observation of detected objects.

12. With all landing craft recovered Navs takes charge of the TG units and you commence the transit East in a screen conducting flying concurrently. The deck landing training is running late FLYCO request an extension to flying and for you to maintain the course for additional 1 hour. This would result in entering the TSS separation zone, the 200W asks if this is allowed as you are restricted in ability to manoeuvre? **(10b i, ii)** (2)

(i) proceed in the appropriate Traffic Lane in the general direction of traffic flow for that Lane;

(ii) so far as practicable keep clear of a traffic Separation Line or Separation Zone;

13. Altering to enter the approach the TSS correctly 10nm prior to TSS the port lookout reports a group of yachts ahead. He reports three yachts from R10 to R30. The second yacht is on a steady bearing.

- a) Who is the give way vessel? **(18a)** (1)
A power-driven vessel underway shall keep out of the way of:
(iv) a sailing vessel.
- b) What action should you take and what should the result of that action be? **(16 & 8c)** (2)
Every vessel which is directed to keep out of the way of another vessel shall, so far as possible, take early and substantial action to keep well clear.
If there is sufficient sea room, alteration of course alone may be the most effective action to avoid a Close-Quarters situation provided that it is made in good time, is substantial and does not result in another Close-Quarters situation.
- c) The last yacht is displaying a cone apex down. What does this indicate? **(25e)** (1)
A vessel proceeding under sail when also being propelled by machinery shall exhibit forward where it can best be seen a conical shape, apex downwards.

14. Now clear of the yachts the sky looks ominously black and visibility begins to reduce in the gloom.

- a) Can you display your navigation lights before sunset? **(20c)** (2)
The lights prescribed by these Rules shall, if carried, also be exhibited from sunrise to sunset in Restricted Visibility and may be exhibited in all other circumstances when it is deemed necessary.
- b) What is the minimum range of your masthead light? **(22a)** (1)
In vessels of 50 metres or more in length:
- a masthead light, 6 miles;
- c) What is the arc of visibility of your stern light? **(21c)** (1)
‘Sternlight’ means a white light placed as nearly as practicable at the stern showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 135 degrees and so fixed as to show the light 67.5 degrees from right aft on each side of the vessel.

15. Rain begins to fall reducing visibility to 6nm. At G10 you make out the following lights and assess that the vessel will be passing clear down you starboard side.

		W	W
		R	W
		W	W
		R	
G	G		

- d) What do these lights indicate? (24a) (2)
A power-driven vessel, possibly over 50m in length, seen from the starboard side, restricted in her ability to manoeuvre engaged in towing operations with a length of tow exceeding 200m.
- e) What is the day signal for this vessel? (24av & 24e) (2)
A diamond shape where it can best be seen on the towing vessel and on the tow.
- f) In restricted visibility what sound signal and at what interval would this vessel sound if both vessels were manned? (35c & 35e) (2)
A vessel Restricted in her Ability to Manoeuvre.... shall, instead of the signals prescribed in paragraphs (a) or (b) of this Rule, sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts.
A vessel Towed or if more than one vessel is Towed the last vessel of the Tow, if manned, shall at intervals of not more than 2 minutes sound four blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by three short blasts. When practicable, this signal shall be made immediately after the signal made by the Towing vessel.

As the passage is proceeding unhindered and, surprisingly, without the constraint of restricted visibility you decide to quiz your YO on his RoR knowledge.

16. a) i) If main propulsion was lost what type of vessel would you become? (3f) (1)
A vessel Not Under Command (NUC)
- ii) What lights would you display by night and; (27a) (1)
A vessel Not Under Command shall exhibit:
(i) two all-round red lights in a vertical line where they can best be seen;
(iii) when making way through the water. sidelights and a sternlight.
NB. NO masthead light
- iii) If in restricted visibility, what sound signal would you make? (35c) (1)
At intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts.
- b) If you stopped making way through the water what difference, if any, would this make to the lights you would display? (27a) (1)
If you were stopped and making no way through the water you would only display two all round red lights in a vertical line.

17. Should the ME's not be able to conduct repairs in time and you ran aground what would the day, night lights and shapes/sound signal be in this instance? (30a, 30d, 35g & 35h) (2)

Anchor lights & two all-round red lights in a vertical line where they can best be seen.

At intervals of not more than one minute give three separate and distinct strokes on the bell immediately before and after a rapid ringing of the bell for about 5 seconds in the forepart of the vessel and immediately after the ringing of the bell the gong shall be sounded rapidly for about 5 seconds in the after part of the vessel

A vessel aground may in addition sound an appropriate whistle signal.

18. Unfortunately the starboard lookout interrupts your quiz to report that one of previously reported sailing vessels have altered course and is now closing at G160.

19. a) What type of situation is this and who is give way? **(13a, b)** (2)

A vessel shall be deemed to be Overtaking when coming up with another vessel from, a direction more than 22.5 degrees abaft her beam, that is, in such a position with reference to the vessel she is Overtaking, that at night she would be able to see only the sternlight of that vessel but neither of her sidelights.

b) The yacht maintains its course and speed and you determine that a close quarters situation is developing. What sound signal shall you make? **(34d)** (1)

When vessels in sight of one another are approaching each other and from any cause either vessel fails to understand the intentions or actions of the other, or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blasts on the whistle. Such signal may be supplemented by a light signal of at least five short and rapid flashes.

c) The yacht carrying on despite repeated sounding of the signal in Q18b. When may you take action to avoid collision by your manoeuvre alone? **(17 aii)** (1)

take action to avoid collision by her manoeuvre alone, as soon as it becomes apparent to her that the vessel required to keep out of the way is not taking appropriate action in compliance with these Rules.

20. You clear all the Sailing vessels and enter the TSS. You have completed flying but your YO wonders if being RAM for flying made you exempt from following the rules. What is your answer and why? **(10i)** (2)

A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre when engaged in an operation for the laying, servicing or picking up of a submarine cable, within a TSS, is exempted from complying with this rule to the extent necessary to carry out the operation.